

Top U.S. Spy Boss Tulsi Gabbard Steps Down for a Heartbreaking Reason

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Imagine being the boss of all U.S. spies, but then having to quit because someone you love is very sick. That's what happened to Tulsi Gabbard. She was the **Director of National Intelligence** the top spy chief in America. On Friday, she said she was **resigning** to take care of her husband, Abraham, who was just diagnosed with a super **rare bone cancer**. "I must step away from public service to be by his side," she wrote. President Trump said she did an "incredible job" and named her deputy, Aaron Lukas, as the acting director. But Gabbard's time in office was unusual. In January, she showed up at an **FBI raid** on an election office in Georgia! The FBI took ballots and voting machines from the 2020 election. Gabbard said she went because President Trump told her to, and she believed election security was a **national security** issue. Many people were surprised because spy chiefs don't usually go to **FBI raids**. Also, last summer, right before the U.S. bombed Iran, Gabbard released a video warning about the dangers of nuclear war. Some officials said she was trying to stop the attack. She had long argued against getting into Middle East wars. Even though she had to leave for a sad reason, some **insiders** say she might have been pushed out anyway because she didn't always agree with the president's team. Her story shows how even the most powerful jobs can be affected by personal tragedy and big disagreements over war and peace.

Word Treasure

Director of National Intelligence -- The top spy chief in the U.S., in charge of all intelligence agencies.

resigning -- Stepping down from a job voluntarily.

rare bone cancer -- A disease where abnormal cells grow in the bones, which is uncommon.

FBI raid -- When agents from the Federal Bureau of Investigation enter a place to search for evidence.

national security -- Keeping a country safe from threats like attacks or spying.

insiders -- People who work inside a government or organization and have private information.

Background you need

The Director of National Intelligence oversees America's spy agencies, like the CIA and NSA, a job created after the 9/11 attacks. The DNI helps the president understand threats to the country.

In 2020, after the presidential election, some people claimed there was cheating, and Georgia became a focus of those disputes. That led to FBI raids on election offices, one of which Gabbard visited.

Last summer, tensions with Iran were high, and some feared a war. Gabbard had long argued against military strikes in the Middle East and spoke out publicly to try to prevent a conflict.

Break it down

WHO: Tulsi Gabbard, the U.S. Director of National Intelligence, and her husband Abraham

WHAT: She resigned to care for her sick husband, but some insiders say she might have been pushed out because of disagreements over war and election security

WHERE: Washington, D.C. (her office), a Georgia election office (FBI raid), and a public video about Iran

WHY: Her husband's cancer diagnosis forced her to step away, and her independent views on avoiding wars and questioning election raids made her a target for removal

Why it matters

Even powerful leaders face tough choices between work and family, and disagreements over war and elections can shake up top government jobs, showing that our world's safety depends on people who sometimes have to put personal life first.

Test what you remember

1. What was Tulsi Gabbard's job before she resigned?
 - (A) Secretary of State
 - (B) Director of National Intelligence
 - (C) FBI Director
 - (D) White House Press Secretary
2. Why did Gabbard say she was resigning?
 - (A) She wanted a different job
 - (B) To take care of her sick husband
 - (C) The president asked her to leave
 - (D) She was moving to another country
3. Who did President Trump name as the acting director?
 - (A) Aaron Lukas
 - (B) Abraham Gabbard
 - (C) Mike Pence
 - (D) Cesar Ramirez
4. What unusual event did Gabbard attend in January?
 - (A) A military parade
 - (B) An FBI raid on an election office in Georgia
 - (C) A meeting with foreign leaders
 - (D) A protest against food prices
5. What did Gabbard warn about in a video last summer?
 - (A) The dangers of climate change
 - (B) The dangers of nuclear war
 - (C) The dangers of food shortages
 - (D) The dangers of election fraud
6. Why might she have been pushed out anyway?
 - (A) She was too old
 - (B) She didn't always agree with the president's team
 - (C) She asked for too much money
 - (D) She broke the law

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: B 3: A 4: B 5: B 6: B

Questions to think about

1. **Tulsi Gabbard:** She felt she had to put her husband's health ahead of her job, showing loyalty to family.
2. **President Trump and her supporters:** They praised her work and understood her personal choice, but some also felt she was a good leader who had different opinions.
3. **Critics and insiders:** They thought her unusual actions, like the FBI raid visit, hurt her credibility, and that she was being forced out because she clashed with the administration.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):